

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 84

By Vital

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend the Tennessee
Department of Transportation and Project
Milkweed.

WHEREAS, the population of monarch butterflies has been dwindling for decades as the pollinator's sole source of food and habitat, milkweed, has drastically declined since 1992; and

WHEREAS, in June 2022, the International Union for Conservation of Nature announced the monarch butterfly had joined the Red List of Threatened Species as Endangered; this marked the first time it had officially been declared at risk of extinction, according to a report from the Monarch Joint Venture, which is a partnership focused on protecting monarch migration across the United States; and

WHEREAS, understanding the importance of this vital pollinator, the Tennessee Department of Transportation (TDOT) initiated Project Milkweed, which provides milkweed seeds to the public for planting; and

WHEREAS, Tennessee residents are able to choose red milkweed, a native perennial found in swamps, river bottomlands, and wet meadows, and common milkweed, another native perennial found in fields, open woods, and roadsides; and

WHEREAS, in 2023, TDOT distributed 780,000 milkweed seed packets to requesting participants in an effort to restore landscapes and preserve habitats for pollinator species, including the monarch butterfly; and

WHEREAS, a year later, TDOT launched its Milkweed Giveaway during National Pollinator Week, distributing 350,000 available seed packets, which the agency believes is a sustainable target that allows it to balance budget with demand from the public; and

WHEREAS, orders can be placed for up to three seed packets, with each packet containing twenty seeds; one order is allowed per person or household, and shipping is restricted to addresses in Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we recognize this tremendous initiative to ensure the survival of the monarch butterfly and the vital pollinators that help to make Tennessee the greenest state in the land of the free and the home of the brave; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we hereby honor and commend the Tennessee Department of Transportation and Project Milkweed on their efforts to restore the monarch butterfly population in the State of Tennessee.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.